

CORRECTION TOOL

THE GAIT & COMPENSATION CORRECTION WORKSHEET

Identify and Correct Movement Compensations

CHASE THE DATA, NOT THE SENSATION.

The Movement Re-patterning Toolkit | Dr. Jonathan Schutza, PT, DPT

Common Compensation Patterns

Identify your patterns and apply corrections

☐ Overstriding

What it looks like: Foot lands too far ahead of center of mass

Correction: Shorten stride, increase cadence 5-10%

Drill: Metronome walking at 170-180 spm

☐ Heavy Heel Strike

What it looks like: Loud, jarring foot landing

Correction: Soften landing, think "quiet feet"

Drill: Barefoot walking on hard surface

☐ No Toe-Off

What it looks like: Failure to push off through big toe

Correction: Focus on big toe push, strengthen hallux

Drill: Toe yoga exercises, sand walking

☐ Crossover Gait

What it looks like: Feet land too close to midline

Correction: Widen stance slightly, engage glutes

Drill: Walk on line, lateral band walks

☐ Excessive Pronation

What it looks like: Foot collapses inward excessively

Correction: Strengthen foot intrinsics, improve control

Drill: Short foot exercise, single-leg balance

☐ Stiff Ankles

What it looks like: Limited dorsiflexion, early heel lift

Correction: Improve ankle mobility, calf flexibility

Drill: Knee-to-wall stretches, ankle circles

Daily Pre-Walk Drill Routine

Complete before each walking session

☐ Short Foot Exercise

Lift arch without curling toes

3 × 30 sec

☐ Toe Spreads

Spread toes wide independently

3 × 10 reps

☐ Heel Raises

Controlled calf raises

3 × 10 reps

☐ Single-Leg Balance

Stand on one foot

3 × 30 sec

☐ Ankle CARs

Controlled articular rotations

5 each direction

☐ Calf Stretch

Wall stretch, knee straight

2 × 30 sec/leg

Important Note

Change **one pattern at a time**. Focus on a single correction for at least one week before adding another. This allows your nervous system to integrate the new pattern without overwhelming it.

My Compensation Assessment

Identify your primary compensation patterns

Primary Compensation (Week 1 Focus) | Secondary (Week 2)

PATTERN	PATTERN
WHEN I NOTICE IT	WHEN I NOTICE IT
CORRECTION CUE	CORRECTION CUE

Progress Tracking

Weekly check-ins on compensation patterns

Week 1 | Week 2 | Week 3 | Week 4 Notes